

Syllabus

Wednesday, January 14, 2026 1:09 PM

Email: Jaclyn.carroll@villanova.edu

OFFICE HOURS: Monday Afternoons, via Zoom & By Appointment

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COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course offers a survey of the study of crime, delinquency, victimization, criminological policy, and the American criminal justice system. It also interrogates the philosophical backdrop of American criminology. It explores both the circumstances of the American criminal justice system as well as the social construction of crime and deviance.

There is a particular focus on how religious, legal, and medical institutions as well as gendered, racialized, and economic power structures effect the management of crime and criminality. Students will refine their comprehension and critical analytical orientation to criminology and demonstrate these abilities through comprehensive examinations and engaging public speaking exercises. They will enrich both their written and oral communication skills and refine their collaborative skills by working in groups to memorize, interpret, and evaluate course content.

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COURSE READINGS

There are no required textbooks for this course. All required information will be provided via lectures and readings assigned on Blackboard.

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COURSE ASSIGNMENTS

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COURSE EXAMS (40%)

- There are two exams in this course, each worth 20% of the final grade. These are old school, in-class quizzes. In this class, you're expected to memorize some material, largely because I want you to feel that you can enter the world ready to discuss important political topics in your everyday life – in other classes, at the dinner table, and in the workplace. Your first exam is on the history of criminology, and your last is on our contemporary legal system.

POD DEBATE (20%)

- In lieu of a third exam, you (and your study pod) will participate in a graded live debate, in order to assess and develop your command of criminological theory. Your pod will prep debate materials, and engage a case study with your peers. While there is no "winning" the debate, your team will be assessed based on the quality of preparation and performance.
 - A note here - While learning to succeed in groups is an important skill, I understand that being assessed in this way can be anxiety-producing. For this reason, all students are welcome to submit individually prepared debate materials, should they be uncomfortable with the work produced by their pod. We will discuss these details as the assignment approaches.

IN CLASS PREP & LEARNING ACTIVITIES (20%)

- I do not take attendance in this class, but you will often participate in in-class assignment prep and learning activities that are graded for completion/participation. During the first week of class, you will be assigned to a "pod" – pods will work together often on in-class assignments and will compete as teams in the debates and quiz-prep jeopardy games.

- Beyond this, the pod is what you like it to be! If you want to study together, create study guides, share notes, that's entirely up to you! They're meant to be helpful, not to be a bother ;)

POLICY MEMOS (20%)

- During the semester you will be asked to produce a few brief (1 pg.) policy memos related to the week's special topic. These are meant to help you explore contemporary politics surrounding crime & justice. You will be encouraged to complete these with your pod, but you may opt to work alone.
- The semester will culminate with one, cumulative, longer policy memo which is due during the final exam period. You do not need to be physically present for this (should it affect your end-of-semester travel) - It is a digital submission on Blackboard.

Extra Credit Opportunities will be Offered Throughout the Semester!

GRADING SCALE

93-100: A 90-92: A- 87-89: B+ 83-86: B 80-82: B- 77-79: C+ 73-76: C 70-72: C- 67-69: D+ 63-66: D 60-62: D- Below 60: F

<https://www1.villanova.edu/villanova/enroll/registrar/policies.html>

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

All students are expected to uphold Villanova's Academic Integrity Policy and Code. Any incident of academic dishonesty will be reported to the Dean of the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences for disciplinary action. You may view the University's Academic Integrity Policy and Code for a detailed description.

Campus Resources

Office of Disabilities (ODS) and Learning Support Services (LSS)

It is the policy of Villanova to make reasonable academic accommodations for qualified individuals with disabilities. All students who need accommodations should go to Clockwork for Students via myNOVA to complete the Online Intake or to send accommodation letters to professors. Go to the LSS website <http://learningsupportservices.villanova.edu> or the ODS website <https://www1.villanova.edu/university/student-life/ods.html> for registration guidelines and instructions. If you have any questions please contact LSS at 610- 519- 5176 or learning.support.services@villanova.edu, or ODS at 610-519-3209 or ods@villanova.edu.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES

Absences for Religious Holidays

Villanova University makes every reasonable effort to allow members of the community to observe their religious holidays, consistent with the University's obligations, responsibilities, and policies. Students who expect to miss a class or assignment due to the observance of a religious holiday should discuss the matter with their professors as soon as possible, normally at least two weeks in advance. Absence from classes or examinations for religious reasons does not relieve students from responsibility for any part of the course work required during the course.

From https://elearning.villanova.edu/webapps/blackboard/content/listContent.jsp?course_id=186618_1&content_id=5699041_1&mode=reset